

The water cycle

All the water on Earth moves around in a cycle. It rises into the air as moisture and clouds. Rain and snow bring it back to the Earth. It then flows along rivers into the oceans, and the cycle goes on.

The Sun plays a key part in the water cycle. It heats the Earth, causing liquid water to become gas.

Water droplets freeze into ice crystals in very high clouds.

Clouds

As water vapour rises, it cools into tiny liquid droplets, which gather to form clouds. This process is called condensation.

Evaporation

Oceans, rivers, and lakes are warmed by the Sun. As they heat up, liquid water at the surface turns into water vapour, which is a gas. This process is called evaporation.

Water has been used to transport people and goods for thousands of years.

Seawater contains minerals, which is why it tastes very salty.